



Twitter makes likes easier

On twttr, the company is testing new, a way to make liking tweets even easier than before.

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Intel exits 5G modem business

Intel says Apple-Qualcomm settlement behind exiting 5G smartphone modem business.

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the ban has officially been withdrawn at the time of writing this, the app is yet to show up once more. Despite this and similar controversies in the past, parent company ByteDance remains bullish about the Indian market. Bytedance has said that they will increase employee strength in India to 1000 by this year, with 25% of them in content moderation.



NewsDog, an early entrant from back in 2016, had initially launched its content aggregation app only in English. However, over the last couple of years, they have come to realise that the one-size fits all approach does not work in India. According to reports, they are currently in the process of launching 5-6 new apps in India that will offer regional-specific content. Offering vernacular inter-

activity is crucial right now because internet connectivity has reached tier-2,3 and 4 cities and towns, where people don't speak English, but also don't have a single unanimous language either.

If most indicators are to be believed, this is just the beginning for India. The App Annie report mentioned earlier pegs India as an experimental market, where users are more open to downloading and trying out newer apps and are yet to develop true habits in terms of app usage. The urban population of India is closer to saturation than ever before when it comes to apps. It's the next wave of users who are yet to have a go-to app for entertainment, payments, e-commerce and more - they will be building the next unicorns of India out of the apps they get addicted to.

Companies are doing all they can, in innovative ways, to make the most of this new user base. Most platforms are offering verified profiles, bringing celebrities on board to create desirable content, even partnering with government agencies for digital campaign strategies. LiveMe has set up three studios in India where it is creating content using local talent likely to be monetised later. Tiktok has been quite successful in developing an influencer ecosystem that is driven purely by content creation, along with interest-

ing marketing strategies like in-app challenges, local trends and more. Their algorithms have a good hold on content suggestions, even for a growing Tier 1 audience.

CONCLUSION

Most of the major names in this space now have some very distinct common threads tying them together. To put it in a sentence, apps are taking a leaf out of the success strategies that have worked in China and are tweaking them for the Indian market to unlock success. However, broadly, there are three things that apps need to get right.

First, the app needs to be relevant and engaging. The popular apps are solving this requirement by making

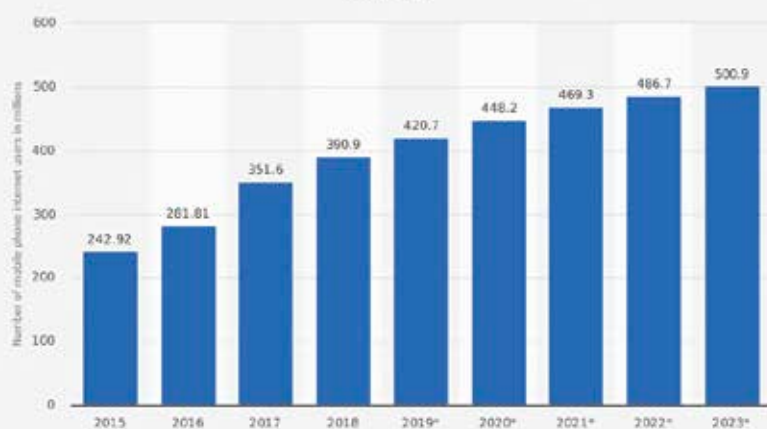


the content on the platform user-generated, which, by design, makes the content local and relevant.

Second, the app needs to make the most of the technology available to serve the users. With cheaper smartphones becoming more powerful, apps are capable of carrying more interesting features that retain engagement. Additionally, having Lite versions of apps helps users plagued by poor internet speeds.

Third, which is something that popular apps are starting to do right now, is to partner with relevant entities in the local market to gain and maintain credibility. This would involve celebrity tie-ups, brand-presence and more. Hence, these three things - content, community and commerce, will determine the future of popular apps in India. 

Number of mobile phone internet users in India from 2015 to 2023 (in millions)



Sources:
Statista, Statista DMO
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Additional information:
India: Statista DMO 2015 to 2018